

Some of the greatest software comes from Linux and Open Source

Linux is home to some of the best new software, and best of all, most of it is free. Installation is a snap these days just by clicking on an icon in the ‘Software Center’ and installing it from a banquet worth of great apps. In Chapter 7 we have a detailed look at some of the fantastic apps out there for Linux, but have a look at just a few of these great titles for starters:

- [LibreOffice/OpenOffice](#)
A fully featured Office suite including a Word Processor, Spreadsheet, Drawing Package, Database and Presentation suite. Compatible with Microsoft Office.
- [Mozilla Firefox](#)
The browser that reloaded the web – all thanks to Open Source! Most other popular web browsers (including Google’s Chrome browser) is also available for Linux.
- [GIMP](#) (GNU Image Manipulation Project)
An excellent open source image editor, similar to Photoshop by Adobe. Used to edit many of the images on this website!
- [VLC Media Player \(VideoLAN\)](#)
A great media player, play your DVDs/VCDs/DiVX’s on any computer, even stream them to another computer connected to a network! VLC is one of the most popular media players available today, and it’s also available for Mac OS X and Windows users, too!
- Evolution (and Thunderbird).
Evolution is a full-featured Groupware client which includes E-Mail, Calendar, Tasks, Address Books and the ability to connect to a Microsoft Exchange mail server.
Thunderbird is a very popular email client which was created for use by the Mozilla Foundation.

Games on Linux? Really!?!

Yep, you read it right! Pacman isn’t just the only game Linux does any more! Steam and SteamOS are de facto Linux platforms now, literally thousands of the games available for Windows/Mac are available on Steam for Linux and whats more, they are usually released around the same date as their Windows counterparts.

And there’s more!...

Those are just some of the titles that you may end up using all the time, however there are literally hundreds of thousands of titles to choose from. Most of them are completely free of charge. Why not [have a sneek peek at Chapter 7 to see more of the most popular titles](#).